

Consulting English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: management consultants, strategy consultants, implementation consultants, analysts, engagement managers, client partners, internal consultants, and advisory teams

Focus: A consulting English curriculum for discovery, hypotheses, stakeholder management, scope, executive recommendations, slide narratives, implementation risk, and client pushback.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Client Discovery and Problem Definition

Situation

A client asks for a benchmark study but describes a decision problem.

Stakeholder pressure: Sell the requested benchmark.

Constraint: Decision question, stakeholders, constraints, and expected use of analysis need clarification.

Terms to use

- discovery
- problem statement
- decision question
- stakeholder

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A client asks for a benchmark study but describes a decision problem.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Sell the requested benchmark.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm discovery, problem statement, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	feedback recovery plan
B	implementation risk brief
C	discovery question guide
D	scope-change response

Module 2. Hypotheses and Issue Trees

Situation

The team has limited data but needs a workplan.

Stakeholder pressure: Analyze everything.

Constraint: Hypotheses, issue tree, prioritization, and evidence plan should focus effort.

Terms to use

- hypothesis
- issue tree
- workstream
- evidence plan

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

The team has limited data but needs a workplan.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Analyze everything.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm hypothesis, issue tree, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	steering committee close
B	issue-tree workplan
C	feedback recovery plan
D	implementation risk brief

Module 3. Data Requests and Client Burden**Situation**

The consulting team sends a long data request to a busy client.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask for everything just in case.

Constraint: Data relevance, owner, confidentiality, deadline, and burden need management.

Terms to use

- data request
- confidentiality
- owner

- deadline

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

The consulting team sends a long data request to a busy client.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask for everything just in case.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm data request, confidentiality, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	owner
C	data request prioritization
D	evidence

Module 4. Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis

Situation

A deck has many charts but no decision narrative.

Stakeholder pressure: Add more detail.

Constraint: So-what, implication, recommendation, and decision ask must be explicit.

Terms to use

- storyline
- so what
- recommendation
- decision ask

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A deck has many charts but no decision narrative.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Add more detail.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm storyline, so what, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	owner
B	executive storyline
C	evidence
D	risk

Module 5. Scope Management and Change Requests

Situation

A client asks for an additional market study mid-project.

Stakeholder pressure: Do it to keep the client happy.

Constraint: Scope, timeline, budget, value, and tradeoff need a formal conversation.

Terms to use

- scope
- change request
- tradeoff
- statement of work

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A client asks for an additional market study mid-project.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Do it to keep the client happy.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm scope, change request, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	scope-change response
B	issue-tree workplan
C	data request prioritization

Option	Phrase
D	executive storyline

Module 6. Difficult Client Feedback

Situation

A client says the recommendation is not practical.

Stakeholder pressure: Defend the model.

Constraint: Implementation constraints, assumptions, and client knowledge should be integrated.

Terms to use

- assumption
- implementation constraint
- stakeholder buy-in
- iteration

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A client says the recommendation is not practical.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Defend the model.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm assumption, implementation constraint, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	evidence
B	risk
C	owner
D	feedback recovery plan

Module 7. Implementation and Change Management

Situation

Leadership approves a new operating model but managers resist.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell managers the decision is final.

Constraint: Change story, incentives, decision rights, training, and adoption metrics matter.

Terms to use

- operating model
- change management
- adoption
- decision rights

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Leadership approves a new operating model but managers resist.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell managers the decision is final.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm operating model, change management, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	implementation risk brief
C	owner
D	scope

Module 8. Steering Committees and Final Readouts**Situation**

Executives disagree during the final readout.

Stakeholder pressure: Keep presenting the slides.

Constraint: Decision rights, options, risks, and next-step ownership need facilitation.

Terms to use

- steering committee
- option set
- risk
- next step

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Executives disagree during the final readout.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Keep presenting the slides.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm steering committee, option set, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	scope
B	timeline
C	assumption
D	steering committee close

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Client Discovery and Problem Definition

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. discovery question guide	A discovery question guide is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Hypotheses and Issue Trees

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. issue-tree workplan	A issue-tree workplan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Data Requests and Client Burden

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. data request prioritization	A data request prioritization is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. executive storyline	A executive storyline is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Scope Management and Change Requests

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. scope-change response	A scope-change response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Difficult Client Feedback

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. feedback recovery plan	A feedback recovery plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Implementation and Change Management

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. implementation risk brief	A implementation risk brief is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Steering Committees and Final Readouts

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. steering committee close	A steering committee close is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.